

Layers Concept

Learning Objectives

- Understand what layers are in graphics software
- Create and manage multiple layers
- Arrange layer order to control visibility

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Think of a traditional puppet show—the background scenery is painted first, then characters are placed in front. Layers work the same way in digital art—each element sits on its own transparent sheet. Let us learn to build pictures layer by layer.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open a graphics program with layer support. Create three layers: background, middle ground, and foreground. Draw a sky on the background layer, hills on the middle, and a tree on the front. Observe how each layer is independent. Try hiding one layer and see what happens.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Layers are like transparent sheets stacked on top of each other. Each layer holds separate parts of a drawing—background, characters, text. You can edit, hide, or rearrange layers without affecting others. This makes complex designs manageable and editable.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Create a simple landscape with at least four layers: sky, mountains, river, and foreground elements. Add a sun on a separate layer and experiment with moving it behind mountains. Discuss with your group why layers make designing easier than drawing everything on one layer.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Explain what a layer is using the transparent sheet analogy. Show how to create, hide, and reorder layers. Draw a simple scene using at least three separate layers.